



FIRST NATIONS PROCUREMENT INCORPORATED (FNPI)



CANCOM Funding and Growth Strategy

Friday, June 5, 2026

FNPI prepared this document for the proposed CANCOM brand. It details the brand's positioning, funding priorities, and suggests actions for obtaining provincial and federal funding.

Recommended Positioning

CANCOM is an Indigenous technology and security company that develops AI, autonomous monitoring systems, and advanced infrastructure for governments, Indigenous communities, and key industry operators.

Federal Funding Priorities

1. Indigenous Services Canada (ISC): Focuses on entrepreneurship, procurement readiness, and capacity building initiatives.
2. NRC IRAP: Supports AI platform development, advancements in drone autonomy, commercialization efforts, and technical staffing solutions.
3. Department of National Defence IDEAS: Engages in surveillance technologies, autonomous systems, AI-assisted monitoring, and ISR innovation.
4. Public Services and Procurement Canada (PSPC): Provides opportunities for Indigenous procurement and supplier engagement.

Ontario Funding Priorities

1. Ontario Centre of Innovation (OCI): AI development commercialization, and technology partnerships.
2. Northern Ontario Heritage Fund Corporation (NOHFC): equipment, hiring, technology development, and expansion.
3. Invest Ontario growth capital and commercialization support once pilot projects and customers are secured.

Recommended Funding Sequence

Phase 1 (0-3 months): Complete finalization of the CANCOM brand, establish ownership structure, secure procurement registrations, prepare capability statements, and develop financial projections.



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Phase 2 (3–6 months): apply for IRAP, OCI, ISC, and NOHFC funding for AI and drone development.

Phase 3 (6–12 months): seek out DND IDEAS opportunities, launch Indigenous community pilot projects, and implement essential infrastructure deployments.

Suggested Taglines

- AI, Security, and Autonomous Drone Systems under Indigenous ownership
- Human-directed, AI-supported, and Indigenous-owned solutions
- Sovereign technology supporting security, monitoring, and infrastructure initiatives

Key Recommendation

Shift the narrative from partnership concept to a fundable technology company founded on products, platforms, intellectual property, commercialization, and measurable economic impact.

Eligibility Criteria for First Nation Businesses

A First Nation business must satisfy specific standards related to ownership, control, and registration. The essential qualifications are outlined below:

Ownership and Control

Indigenous Ownership: At least 51% of the business must be owned and controlled by Indigenous persons.

Joint Ventures: Joint ventures also require a minimum 51% Indigenous business ownership.

Registration Requirements

Indigenous businesses seeking federal contracts through PSIB must be listed in the Indigenous Business Directory or on a modern treaty business list.

Additional Considerations

Evidence of Eligibility: Businesses must submit proof of ownership and control.



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Types of Business Structures: Eligible entities include sole proprietorships, partnerships, limited companies, cooperatives, and not-for-profits.